

About JSON

JSON (JavaScript Object Notation), is a text-based format for storing & exchanging data. It's a popular data format that's used in web development, data analysis, & software engineering. Characteristics to know about JSON are given below:

- **Human-readable** - JSON is easy to read by humans and understand by computers.
- **Machine-parsable**: Computers can easily understand JSON.
- **Language-independent** - JSON is not tied to any specific programming language, so it can be used to exchange data across different platforms and programming languages.
- **Data representation** - JSON represents data in two ways: objects and arrays.
 - **Objects**: A collection of name-value pairs, defined by left and right braces.
 - **Arrays**: An ordered collection of values, defined by left and right brackets.
- **Common use** - JSON is commonly used to transmit data in web applications, like sending data from a server to a web page.

About JSON ... cont'd

- **Similar to JavaScript** - JSON is similar to JavaScript objects in the way it's written and stored, but JSON only has properties and no methods.
- **More flexible than HTML** - JSON is more flexible than HTML and allows for more complex data structures.

Alternatives to JSON:

YAML, TOML, XML, CSV, MessagePack, HJSON, CBOR, YAML 1.2